RABBIT SOUP WITH CORN DUMPLINGS

serves 4 to 6

Throughout many parts of Turtle Island, from Mexico to southern Canada, people historically ate various forms of dumplings, breads, and cakes made from nixtamalized corn. The dumplings here are inspired by Mexican chochoyotes, which have a divot in the center to help them cook through and capture some of the broth.

- 1 medium yellow onion
- 1 rabbit (about 2¼ pounds), cut into 6 serving pieces (rib cage removed)
- Sea salt
- 1 tablespoon crumbled dried prairie sage or culinary sage
- 1 large carrot, scrubbed well and coarsely chopped
- 3 tablespoons maple syrup, plus more as needed
- 2 tablespoons sunflower oil
- 1 pound Fresh Masa (page 28) or use masa harina (see chart, page 27)
- 2 tablespoons melted duck fat or sunflower oil
- Thinly sliced wild onion greens or scallion greens, for serving

Cut the onion in half. Coarsely chop one half and cut the other half into ½-inch pieces

Place the rabbit pieces in a large pot, cover with water, and season generously with salt. Add the sage, coarsely chopped onion, carrot, and maple syrup and bring to a boil over high heat. Reduce the heat to medium-low, cover, and simmer for about 1½ hours, or until the meat is so tender that it pulls apart.

Using tongs, transfer the rabbit to a plate to cool slightly. Strain the broth into a clean pot (discarding any solids), then taste and season with more salt and maple syrup, as needed. Keep the broth warm over medium-low heat.

When the meat is cool enough to handle, pull it from the bones. Be very careful to remove all of the rabbit bones, as they are small.

In a large skillet, heat the oil over medium heat until shimmering. Add the diced onion, season with salt, and cook, stirring, for about 5 minutes, or until softened. Add the pulled rabbit meat, taste and season with more salt and a little bit of maple syrup.

Set a piece of parchment paper on a baking sheet or a work surface. In a large bowl, combine the masa and fat or oil. Test the dough by rolling it into a small ball and pressing it to about ½ inch thick. If the edges crack, add warm water 1 teaspoon at a time and knead for 1 minute, adding more water as needed until the dough is soft and no longer cracks.

Using a 1-ounce scoop, portion the dough into 20 pieces and roll into balls. Press your thumb into each one to create a divot in the center.

Bring the rabbit broth to a simmer and drop the dumplings gently into the broth. Simmer for about 10 minutes, or until the dumplings are cooked through and tender. Be careful not to overcook them or they will begin to fall apart in the broth.

Add the pulled rabbit meat to the broth just to warm it through.

Ladle the rabbit, broth, and dumplings into bowls and garnish with the onion greens. Serve hot.

ON MASA HARINA

Masa harina allows you to make masa more easily at home. The flour, made from nixtamalized, dehydrated, and ground corn, lets you just add water. For many years, Maseca was the only widely available brand of masa harina, but you can now find better-quality versions online and at some markets.

Masienda (masienda.com), for example, makes masa harina from four different colors of corn, all sourced from heirloom corn grown in Mexico. Bob's Red Mill makes their masa harina from organic yellow corn and King Arthur Flour uses organic white corn.

You can make any of the recipes in the book that call for fresh masa using masa harina. Below are some rough equivalencies. Know that when you use masa harina, you might often end up with a little extra than what's called for in the recipe, but that's okay.

FRESH MASA (by WEIGHT)	MASA HARINA	FINE SEA SALT	WARM WATER
8 ounces	1 cup	pinch	¾ cup
1 pound	1¾ cups	¼ teaspoon	1⅓ cups
1½ pounds	2½ cups	⅜ teaspoon	2 scant cups
2 pounds	3½ cups	½ teaspoon	2⅔ cups

THE METHOD In a bowl, stir together the masa harina and salt, then add the warm water. Knead to form a soft dough, making sure no dry spots remain. Cover and let stand for 20 minutes to 1 hour to allow the flour to fully hydrate before using the masa.

You might need to add a little more water or masa harina to achieve the proper texture, which will depend on the recipe.